

Data Validation



Validation

With any data entry, it is important to reduce the likelihood of erroneous (incorrect) data

Erroneous data can come from a range of sources, for example:

- User mistyping input (e.g. meaning to type 5 but typing 4 by mistake)
- User misunderstanding input requirements (e.g. Asked to confirm (Y/N) but entering “OK”)
- Misinformation (e.g. A person has hand written a number as 1 but it looks like a 7).



Validation

With any data entry, it is important to reduce the likelihood of erroneous (incorrect) data

Validation is the process of ensuring that data entered into a database meets a certain rule or rules in order to reduce the input of erroneous data.

Validation cannot prevent erroneous data from being input, but it can help.



Presence Check

A presence check can be used to ensure that data must be entered in a field.

For example:

- Postcode
- DOB

WARNING



Please enter a value for postcode

Field Length Check

A field length check can be used to limit the number of characters in a field.

For example:

- Forename (e.g. maximum 12 characters)
- Surname (e.g. maximum 15 characters)
- Postcode (e.g. maximum 8 characters)

Please enter your postcode

EH145 2BB

WARNING



Postcode too long – maximum 8 characters

Range Check

A range check can be used to ensure that data falls between two values.

For example:

- Enter a date (1 to 31)
- Enter a rating (0 to 100)
- Enter the temperature (-50 to 50)

Please enter height in cm (0-300)

341

WARNING



Please enter a value between 0 and 300

Restricted Choice Check

A restricted choice check can be used to limit the user entry to a list of acceptable values.

For example:

- Day of week (Mon, Tue, Wed, Thu, Fri, Sat, Sun)
- Driving licence (Full, Provisional, None)
- Gender (Male, Female)
- Salutation (Mr, Mrs, Miss, Ms, Master, Lord, Lady, Other)

Please enter airport (EDI, GLA, ABZ, INV)

WARNING

Please enter a valid value



Restricted Choice Check

Restricted choice check is often used with drop down menus to enhance validation.

Define Domestic Country: US - United States

- TT - Trinidad and Tobago
- TN - Tunisia
- TR - Turkey
- TM - Turkmenistan
- TC - Turks and Caicos Islands
- TV - Tuvalu
- UG - Uganda
- UA - Ukraine
- AE - United Arab Emirates
- GB - United Kingdom
- US - United States**

Car Make: BMW Car Model: 3 Series

- 3 Series
- 5 Series
- 6 Series
- 7 Series
- M
- M5
- M6
- X3
- X5
- Z4

Mon 10/29/2007 9:00 AM

October 2007

Su	Mo	Tu	We	Th	Fr	Sa
	1	2	3	4	5	6
7	8	9	10	11	12	13
14	15	16	17	18	19	20
21	22	23	24	25	26	27
28	29	30	31			

4:30 AM
5:00 AM
5:30 AM
6:00 AM
6:30 AM
7:00 AM
7:30 AM
8:00 AM
8:30 AM
9:00 AM
9:30 AM
10:00 AM
10:30 AM
11:00 AM
11:30 AM
12:00 PM
12:30 PM
1:00 PM
1:30 PM
2:00 PM
2:30 PM
3:00 PM
3:30 PM
4:00 PM
4:30 PM
5:00 PM